

Literary Analysis of *The Great Gatsby*

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1 Introduction

The Great Gatsby by F. Scott Fitzgerald (Fitzgerald 1925) is a classic American novel that explores the decadence of the Roaring Twenties. Through the tragic story of Jay Gatsby, Fitzgerald critiques the American Dream and its inherent contradictions. This analysis will examine key thematic elements and stylistic features of the novel.

2 development

As demonstrated by Liu (2010), Fitzgerald's prose in *The Great Gatsby* employs sophisticated linguistic techniques. The narrative structure, characterized by Nick Carraway's retrospective point of view, creates a sense of nostalgia and moral judgment. Recent scholarship (Jiang 2019) has further illuminated the novel's enduring relevance in contemporary literary studies.

The symbolic use of colors—particularly green, white, and gold—serves to reinforce thematic concerns about wealth, purity, and corruption. Gatsby's pursuit of Daisy Buchanan represents not only personal obsession but also the broader cultural fascination with status and reinvention.

3 Conclusion

In conclusion, *The Great Gatsby* remains a profound exploration of ambition, love, and societal decay. Fitzgerald's masterpiece continues to resonate with readers nearly a century after its publication, offering timeless insights into human nature and the complexities of the American experience.

References

- Fitzgerald, F. Scott (1925). *The Great Gatsby*. New York: Charles Scribner's Sons.
- Jiang, J. (2019). "The Great Gatsby". In: *2019 4th International Conference on Humanities*.

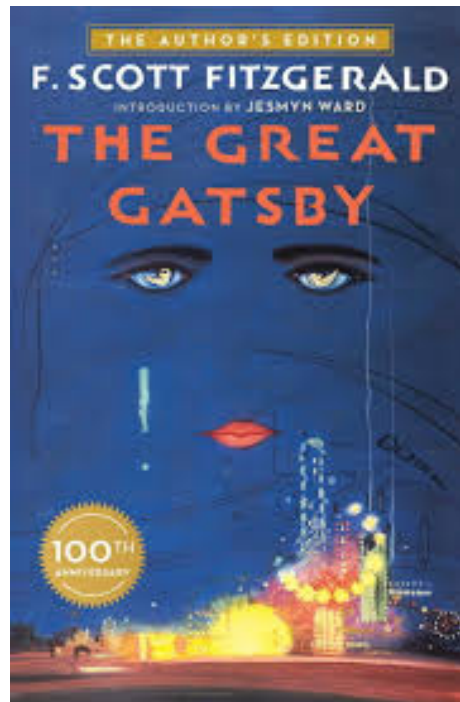


Figure 1: Cover of *The Great Gatsby* (1925)

Liu, Xia (2010). "Linguistic analysis of *The Great Gatsby* from lexical and grammatical category". In: *Journal of Language Teaching and Research* 1.5, pp. 654–661.